SAROJINI NAIDU

1879–1949



In 1898, Sarojini Chattopadhyay married Govindarajulu Naidu, a young doctor she had fallen in love with some years earlier. Marrying outside of her caste was only one of the many unconventional choices Sarojini would make.

“AS LONG AS I HAVE LIFE, AS LONG AS BLOOD FLOWS THROUGH THIS ARM OF MINE, I SHALL NOT LEAVE THE CAUSE OF FREEDOM…I AM ONLY A WOMAN, ONLY A POET. BUT AS A WOMAN, I GIVE TO YOU THE WEAPONS OF FAITH AND COURAGE AND THE SHIELD OF FORTITUDE. AND AS A POET, I FLING OUT THE BANNER OF SONG AND SOUND, THE BUGLE CALL TO BATTLE.”

A progressive family